SAP MM • S/4HANA 2023

Flexible Workflow Process

for Purchase Order Release Procedure

Portfolio Project – Training System

System	SAP S/4HANA 2023
Module	SAP MM / Release Strategy
Environment	SAP Training System (Demo)

Note: Developed in SAP Training System for demonstration and portfolio purposes.

1. Project Overview

The Flexible Release Procedure for Purchase Orders (POs) is implemented in SAP S/4HANA 2023 to streamline the approval process and adapt to varying business scenarios. This configuration allows dynamic control of PO releases based on multiple criteria such as document type, purchase organization, value thresholds, and release codes.

By adopting this flexible workflow, the organization ensures faster approval cycles, reduced manual intervention, and enhanced compliance with procurement policies. Approval levels can flex based on circumstances such as leave or public holidays, giving Procurement Supervisors, Leads, and Heads the agility to manage approvals without bottlenecks.

PO approvals are now managed digitally through SAP Fiori applications, where release approvers can view, approve, or reject purchase orders in real time. The workflow automatically triggers approval tasks based on predefined conditions — eliminating the need for manual intervention through SAP GUI.

2. Business Objectives & Key Benefits

2.1 Business Objectives

- Automate PO approval routing based on configurable business rules
- Replace manual, paper-based release strategy with a digital workflow
- Provide flexibility to accommodate real-world scenarios (leave, delegation)
- Ensure compliance with organizational procurement and spending policies

2.2 Key Benefits

Benefit	Description
Faster Approvals	Workflows trigger automatically based on PO value and type — no manual routing needed.
Digital Processing	Approvers use SAP Fiori to review and act on POs from any device, in real time.
Flexible Thresholds	Low-value POs (< 1,000 GBP) are auto-released; higher values route to approvers.
Scalable Design	Multiple workflows can be stacked for different document types, organizations, or value bands.
Audit & Compliance	Full digital trail of approvals and rejections maintained within SAP.

3. Scope & Configuration Summary

The following configuration items were delivered as part of this implementation:

Configuration Item	Details / Setting	Status
Scenario Activation	Activate Flexible Workflow scenario in SPRO	Activated
Activate Flexible Workflow for PO	Enabled for Document Type: DNB	Activated
Create Workflow in SAP Fiori	Auto-release for PO Net Order Value < 1,000 GBP	Created & Active
Workflow Trigger	Based on PO value, document type & purchasing group	Configured

4. Configuration Steps

The configuration was carried out via SPRO (SAP Project Reference Object) and SAP Fiori. The steps below document each configuration activity in sequence.

4.1 Scenario Activation

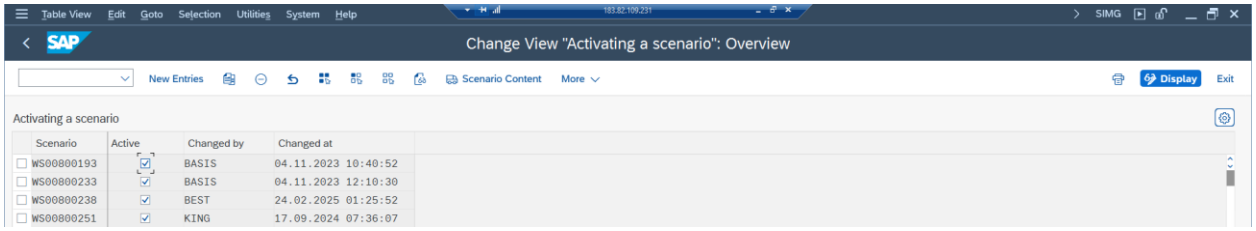
The Flexible Workflow scenario must first be activated at the system level before any document-type-specific settings can be applied.

SPRO Navigation Path:

```
SPRO → SAP Reference IMG → Materials Management → Purchasing → Purchase Order → Flexible Workflow for Purchase Orders → Scenario Activation
```

Action taken:

- Opened the Scenario Activation screen via SPRO
- Located the Flexible Workflow for Purchase Orders scenario
- Activated the scenario to enable the feature at client level



4.2 Activate Flexible Workflow for Purchase Orders

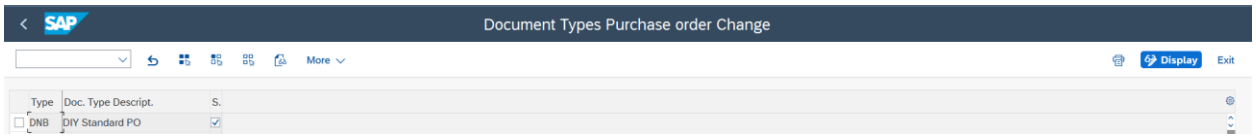
Once the scenario is active, the flexible workflow is enabled for a specific PO document type. In this project, it was activated for document type DNB.

SPRO Navigation Path:

```
SPRO → SAP Reference IMG → Materials Management → Purchasing → Purchase Order → Flexible Workflow for Purchase Orders → Activate Flexible Workflow for Purchase Orders
```

Action taken:

- Navigated to the Activate Flexible Workflow configuration screen
- Selected Document Type: DNB
- Activated the flexible workflow for this document type



4.3 Create the Workflow in SAP Fiori

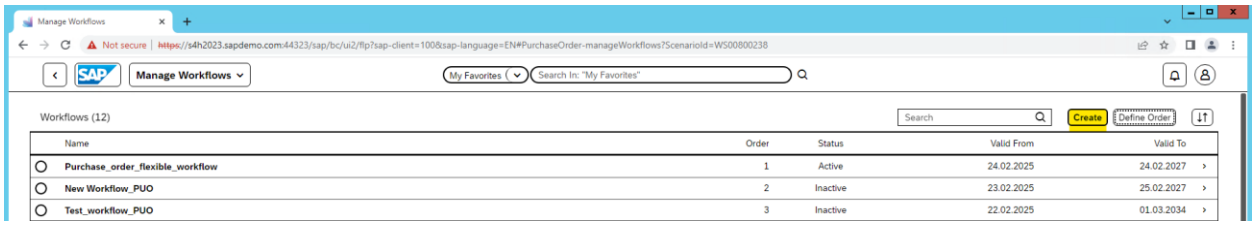
The actual workflow rules — including conditions and approver assignments — are created and managed via the SAP Fiori app “Manage Workflows for Purchase Orders”.

SAP Fiori Navigation:

```
SAP Fiori Launchpad → Search: “Manage Workflows for Purchase Orders” → Create
```

Workflow Conditions Configured:

Condition Parameter	Value / Rule
Document Type	DNB
Trigger Condition	Total Net Order Value < 1,000 GBP
Workflow Action	Automatic Release (no manual approver required)
Workflow Status	Active



Workflow for Purchase Order /

Automatic Release of Purchase Orders for Order Value Less than 1000GBP

Header | Properties | Start Conditions | Steps

Workflow Name:*

Automatic Release of Purchase Orders for Order Value Less than 1000GBP

Properties

Description:

This workflow automatically releases the Purchase Orders for which the Total net Order Value Less than 1000GBP

Valid From:

02.11.2025

Valid To:

31.12.9999

Start Conditions

Only start the workflow if all of the following preconditions are met:

Company code of purchase order is	DIY1	
Purchasing organization of purchase order is	PG1	
Total net amount of purchase order is less than or equal to	1,000.00	GBP

Create Alternative Preconditions

Steps

Workflow Steps

Create | Delete

Type	Name	Recipients	Step Conditions	Is Optional Step
	1. Automatic Release of Purchase Order	Determined automatically	Company code of purchase order is DIY1 Purchasing organization of purchase order is PG1	

Manage Workflows

183.82.109.231

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Manage Workflows | My Favorites | Search In: "My Favorites"

Workflows (13)

Search | Create | Edit | Copy | Activate | Define Order | Delete

Name	Order	Status	Valid From	Valid To
Automatic Release of Purchase Orders for Order Value Less than 1000GBP	1	Draft	02.11.2025	31.12.9999
Purchase_order_flexible_workflow	2	Active	24.02.2025	24.02.2027
New Workflow_PUO	3	Inactive	23.02.2025	25.02.2027
Test_workflow_PUO	4	Inactive	22.02.2025	01.03.2034
Test Workflow for Purchase order	5	Inactive	22.02.2025	23.02.2026

Manage Workflows

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Workflows (13)

Search | Create | Copy | Deactivate | Define Order

Name	Order	Status	Valid From	Valid To
Automatic Release of Purchase Orders for Order Value Less than 1000GBP	1	Active	02.11.2025	31.12.9999
Purchase_order_flexible_workflow	2	Active	24.02.2025	24.02.2027
New Workflow_PUO	3	Inactive	23.02.2025	25.02.2027
Test_workflow_PUO	4	Inactive	22.02.2025	01.03.2034
Test Workflow for Purchase order	5	Inactive	22.02.2025	23.02.2026

5. Testing & Validation

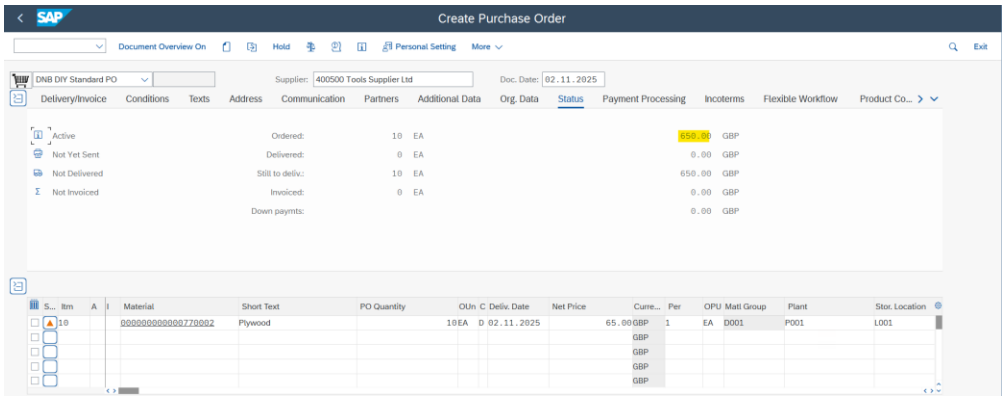
To confirm the workflow operates correctly, a test Purchase Order was created under the configured conditions.

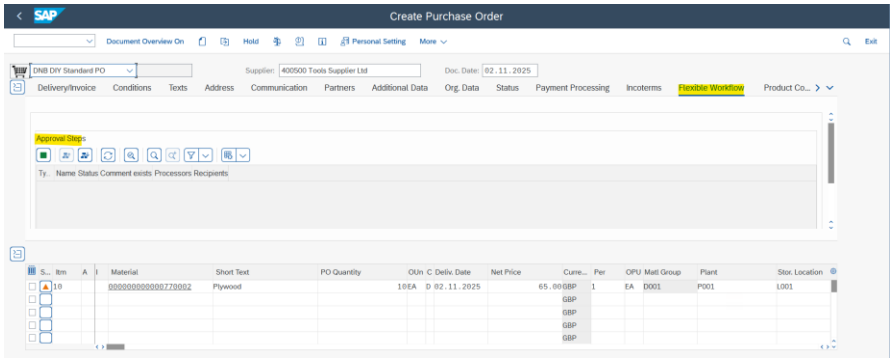
5.1 Test Scenario

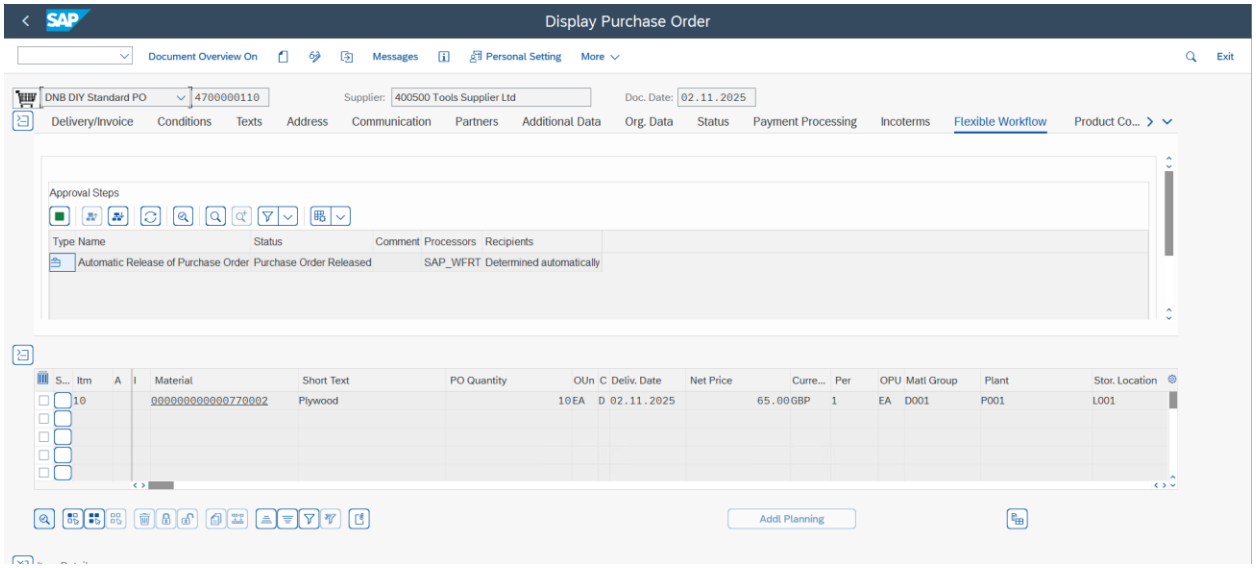
Test Parameter	Value
PO Document Type	DNB
Total Net Order Value	< 1,000 GBP
Expected Behaviour	Flexible Workflow tab appears; Release Strategy tab absent
Workflow Trigger	Auto-release triggered based on value threshold

5.2 Validation Results

- A Purchase Order was created with a Total Net Order Value below 1,000 GBP using document type DNB.
- The traditional Release Strategy tab was no longer visible on the PO — confirming the flexible workflow has replaced it.
- A Flexible Workflow tab appeared on the PO, confirming the new process is active.
- The configured workflow was triggered automatically, processing the PO release without manual approver intervention.







✓ **Validation Passed – Flexible Workflow triggered successfully for PO values below 1,000 GBP.**

6. Extensibility & Design Considerations

The workflow design is intentionally modular and scalable to support future business requirements:

- Multiple Workflows: Additional workflows can be created for different value bands (e.g., 1,000–10,000 GBP, 10,000+ GBP), document types, or purchasing organisations.
- Manual Approval Option: Workflows can be configured with named approvers or role-based approvers for scenarios requiring human sign-off.
- Delegation Support: The flexible structure accommodates leave, delegation, and escalation rules to prevent approval bottlenecks.
- Fiori-First: All approvals are handled via SAP Fiori apps, enabling mobile and remote approval capabilities.
- No SAP GUI Dependency: The workflow eliminates the need for approvers to access SAP GUI, reducing training overhead and improving user experience.

7. Technical Summary

Component	Details
SAP Platform	SAP S/4HANA 2023
Module	SAP Materials Management (MM)
Sub-Module	Purchasing – Purchase Order Release Strategy
Configuration Tool	SPRO / SAP Fiori (Manage Workflows for POs)
Document Type Configured	DNB
Workflow Condition	Net Order Value < 1,000 GBP → Auto Release
Approver Interface	SAP Fiori Launchpad (Manage Workflows for Purchase Orders)
Environment	SAP Training System (Demo / Portfolio)

> *Note: This configuration was developed and validated in an SAP Training System environment for demonstration and portfolio purposes only.*